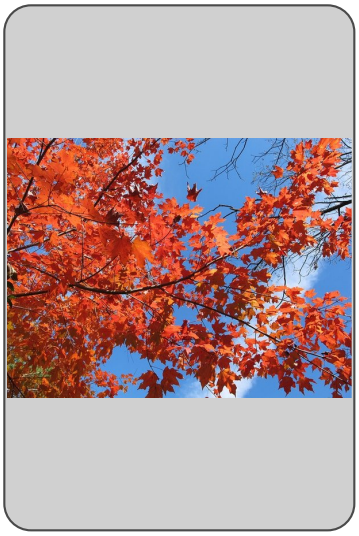
Acer leucoderme

Chalk Maple, Whitebark Maple

Family: Sapindaceae



HABIT



FALL



LEAF



BARK

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Small tree or large shrub

Evergreen or deciduous
Deciduous

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: 25–30 ft (7.5–9 m) high × 15–30 ft (4.5–9 m) wide., often multi-trunked, with rounded crown. rate

Sun

Water

Soil
Adaptable to moist or dry soils; prefers well-drained. Tolerates rocky or understory conditions

Zone 8a
Hardy in USDA Zones 5–9. Native to the Southeast (North Carolina to Florida, west to Texas), including Georgia Piedmont. Excellent for Atlanta Zone 8a. Performs well in understory or as a small shade tree. Fall color yellow to scarlet.
Chalky white bark on mature trunks

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Native to the southeastern United States: inner coastal plain and Piedmont of Georgia and adjacent states. Understory of moist, rocky soils on river banks, ravines, woods, and cliffs. Often multi-stemmed in the wild

Form
Deciduous small tree or large shrub with rounded form. Leaves 5–8 cm, 3–5 lobed, yellow-green beneath. Bright yellow to scarlet fall color. Bark chalky white to light gray on mature trees, ridged and darker at base with age. Small greenish-yellow flowers in spring. Winged seeds (samaras). Small southern relative of sugar maple. Distinctive chalky white bark. Reliable fall color. Adaptable to shade and drier soils. Often confused with Acer floridanum but smaller with different leaf undersides. Native and well-suited to Atlanta

Foliage
Not stated

Flowers and fruit
Not stated

Bark
Not stated

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment

Plant in full sun to shade with well-drained soil. Prune to single trunk if desired. Excellent small shade or understory tree. Slow-growing. Good urban tolerance on dry sites. Minimal fertilizer needed. Fall color and bark are key ornamental features

HEALTH

Health

Few problems. Environmental stresses are the main concern. Generally pest-free under good conditions. Drought and shade tolerant. Less available in nursery trade than other maples

Symptoms

None stated